

Website Usability Checklist

A practical website usability checklist for UI/UX designers, web designers, developers, freelancers, and students. Use it as a website UX checklist to review navigation, content, forms, mobile usability, accessibility, performance, and overall user experience before launching a website.

1. Pick a journey
Choose the main task a visitor should complete, such as contacting you or buying a product.

2. Review each section
Tick an item only when it is true on both desktop and mobile.

3. Fix and retest
Note anything unchecked, fix the highest-impact issues first, then review again.

Quick 15-Point Website UX Review

Short on time? Start with these 15 high-priority checks. They catch the usability issues that most often stop visitors from completing their goal.

☐ Website purpose is immediately clear	☐ Primary CTA is visible
☐ Main navigation is visible and menu labels are clear	☐ Important pages are easy to find
☐ Content is easy to scan	☐ Buttons clearly communicate their action
☐ No broken links exist	☐ Required form fields are identified
☐ Form error messages are understandable	☐ Website works on mobile without horizontal overflow
☐ Buttons and links are easy to tap on mobile	☐ Text has sufficient contrast
☐ Focus states are visible for keyboard users	☐ Core content loads quickly
☐ The main user journey has been tested end to end	

Full Website Usability Checklist

Use the complete checklist for a thorough website UX audit before launch or during a redesign.

01 Navigation

☐ Navigation is easy to understand

☐ Main navigation is visible

☐ Menu labels are clear

☐ Important pages are easy to find

☐ Navigation structure is consistent

☐ Users can return to the homepage easily

☐ Breadcrumbs are used where useful

☐ Mobile navigation is easy to use

02 Homepage

☐ Website purpose is immediately clear

☐ Main headline explains the value clearly

☐ Primary CTA is visible

☐ Important information appears above the fold where appropriate

☐ Content hierarchy is clear

☐ Trust signals are visible where relevant

☐ Homepage is not overloaded with unnecessary content

03 Content

☐ Content is easy to scan

☐ Headings are descriptive

☐ Paragraphs are not unnecessarily long

☐ Important information is easy to find

☐ Language is clear and concise

☐ Spelling and grammar are correct

☐ Calls to action are clear

☐ Content matches user intent

04 Links & Buttons

☐ Links are descriptive

☐ Buttons clearly communicate their action

☐ Primary and secondary actions are visually distinct

☐ Buttons are large enough to use comfortably

☐ Hover states work

☐ Focus states are visible

☐ No broken links exist

05 Forms

☐ Form purpose is clear

☐ Labels are visible

☐ Required fields are identified

☐ Fields have appropriate input types

☐ Error messages are understandable

☐ Validation is clear

☐ Success feedback is provided

☐ Forms do not ask for unnecessary information

☐ Forms are usable on mobile

06 Mobile Usability

☐ Website works on mobile

☐ Content does not overflow horizontally

☐ Text remains readable

☐ Buttons are easy to tap

☐ Navigation works correctly

☐ Forms work correctly

☐ Images scale properly

☐ Important content is not hidden

☐ Mobile spacing is comfortable

07 Accessibility

A quick website accessibility checklist. For a full audit, test against WCAG guidelines.

☐ Text has sufficient contrast

☐ Images have appropriate alt text

☐ Keyboard navigation works where applicable

☐ Focus states are visible

☐ Headings follow logical hierarchy

☐ Form labels are accessible

☐ Information is not communicated by color alone

☐ Interactive elements are identifiable

☐ Touch targets are appropriately sized

08 Visual Design

☐ Typography is consistent

☐ Colors are consistent

☐ Spacing is consistent

☐ Alignment is consistent

☐ Components use consistent styles

☐ Icons are consistent

☐ Visual hierarchy is clear

☐ Design supports usability rather than distracting from it

09 Performance

☐ Images are optimized

☐ Unnecessary large assets are avoided

☐ Pages load efficiently

☐ Fonts are optimized

☐ Animations do not negatively affect usability

☐ Third-party scripts are minimized where possible

☐ Core content loads quickly

10 Trust & Conversion

☐ Contact information is available where appropriate

☐ Important policies are easy to find

☐ CTA wording is clear

☐ Users understand what happens after clicking a CTA

☐ Pricing or important conditions are transparent

☐ Forms explain why information is requested

☐ Trust signals are appropriate for the website

11 Error Handling

☐ 404 page exists

☐ Broken states are handled

☐ Form errors are understandable

☐ Empty states are useful

☐ Network/loading states are considered

☐ Users can recover from errors easily

12 Final UX Review

☐ Test the main user journey

☐ Test on desktop

☐ Test on mobile

☐ Test important forms

☐ Check important links

☐ Review accessibility

☐ Review content

☐ Review visual consistency

☐ Check page speed

☐ Remove unnecessary friction

Website Usability Tips for Beginners

These website usability best practices will help you use the checklist well and make better decisions when an item is not a simple yes or no.

Design for the user's goal

Start every page by asking what the visitor came to do. Remove or reduce anything that does not help them get there.

Keep navigation predictable

Put menus where people expect them and use familiar labels such as "Services" or "Contact". Clever names slow users down.

Reduce unnecessary steps

Every extra click, field, or popup is a chance for users to give up. Combine or remove steps that do not add value.

Make important actions obvious

The primary action on a page should stand out through size, color, and position. Avoid several competing primary buttons.

Use clear content hierarchy

Descriptive headings, short paragraphs, and lists help people scan and find what matters without reading everything.

Test with real users

Watching even three to five people try a task reveals problems you will not notice yourself. Ask them to think aloud.

Check mobile experience

Many visitors arrive on a phone. Test on a real device, not only a resized browser window, and complete a full task.

Consider accessibility from the beginning

Contrast, labels, alt text, and keyboard support are far easier to build in early than to fix after launch.

Do not rely only on visual appearance to judge usability

A website can look polished and still be hard to use. Judge it by whether people can complete their tasks quickly and confidently, not only by how it looks.

Review notes

Website / page reviewed · Date · Top issues to fix first